

YUXING LIANG

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics Concordia University, Montréal, Canada	2020–Expected 2026
M.A. in Economics Concordia University, Montréal, Canada	2018–2020
B.A. in Economics Shanghai Customs College, Shanghai, China	2014–2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Fields: Matching Theory, Market Design, Mechanism Design, Experimental and Empirical Market Design.
Topics: Strategy-proofness, preference elicitation, assignment mechanisms, school choice, college and major assignment, behavioral market design, and quantitative methods.

JOB MARKET PAPER

Decision-Relevance and Irrelevant Questions: Deviation in Strategy-Proof Matching Mechanisms

Abstract. Strategy-proof mechanisms make truthful reporting a weakly dominant strategy, yet agents often submit rank-order lists that differ from their true preferences. This paper argues that many such deviations are not formal manipulations, but responses to informational redundancy in complete-list elicitation. I introduce a decision-relevance framework that separates report changes that can affect an agent's allocation from report changes that are allocation-equivalent to truthful reporting. Under strategy-proofness, the report space decomposes into a zero-incentive truth-equivalence class and a positive-cost region. I characterize this structure in Serial Dictatorship and develop quantitative implications for Deferred Acceptance in large markets, where only a small prefix of the submitted list is typically used. Using experimental evidence from Li (2017) and its reanalysis by Dreyfuss, Heffetz, and Rabin (2022), I show that deviations are more frequent on theoretically irrelevant comparisons and that a substantial share of misreporting rounds are allocatively costless. The results suggest that observed deviations under strategy-proof mechanisms partly reflect over-elicitation by the mechanism rather than cognitive failure alone, with implications for truncation and sequential elicitation design.

WORKING PAPER

Towards a Better Major Assignment: An Empirical Study with Students in China (with Xintong Han and Yan Zeng), *submitted*.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Progressive Choice Mechanisms in School Choice Problems (with Szilvia Pápai).
Bridging Theory and Evidence: How External Information Transforms Students' Application Decisions.

PRESENTATIONS

18th Meeting of the Society for Social Choice and Welfare (SSCW 2026), University of Tokyo, Tokyo, Japan, June 2026.
20th CIREQ-CIRANO Ph.D. Students' Conference, CIRANO, Montreal, Canada, May 2026.
CIREQ Interdisciplinary PhD Conference in Applied Market Design, Concordia University, Montreal, Canada, March 2026.
Workshop: Management Science Series (Virtual), Universidad Católica de Chile, Chile, Oct 2025.
14th Conference on Economic Design, University of Essex, UK, June 2025.
17th Meeting of the Society for Social Choice and Welfare (SSCW 2024), Paris School of Economics, Paris,

France, July 2024.

Concordia Lunch Seminar, Concordia University, Montreal, Canada, Nov 2023.

Urban and Education Economics Seminars, Shandong University, Qingdao, China, July 2023.

13th Conference on Economic Design (CoED2023), Universitat de Girona, Girona, Spain, Jun 2023.

18th CIREQ Ph.D. Students' Conference, Concordia University, Montreal, Canada, May 2023.

Agents Behaviour in Combinatorial Game Theory, CRM Montreal (Virtual), Montreal, Canada, Nov 2021.

PROJECTS

Matching and Assignment Simulation Toolkit

MATLAB, Python

Developed simulation routines for assignment mechanisms, including algorithm implementation, allocation diagnostics, and robustness checks for market-design applications.

Discrete-Choice and Preference-Data Modeling

Python (PyTorch), Stata

Implemented logistic and discrete-choice models for preference prediction, behavioral analysis, and empirical market-design applications.

Applied Data and Market Analytics Workflow

Python

Built an independent data-processing workflow for financial-market data, statistical price-map construction, intraday evidence organization, volatility diagnostics, and visualization.

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Research Experience

- Research Assistant, Shanghai Customs College, 2017–2018.
- Research Assistant, Concordia University, Winter 2023.

Teaching Experience

Lecturer

- ECON 377 The Asia-Pacific Rim Economies, Winter 2024
- ECON 221 Statistical Methods I, Winter 2025
- ECON 491/591 Environmental Economics, Winter 2026
- ECON 436/536 Economics of Taxation, Fall 2026

Tutorial Leader

- ECON 612 Microeconomics I, Concordia University, Winter 2023

Teaching Assistant, Graduate Level

- ECON 642 Financial Economics I, Concordia University, Fall 2024
- ECON 695 Empirical Industrial Organization, Concordia University, Fall 2023
- ECON 612 Microeconomics I, Concordia University, Winter 2023
- ECON 673 Industrial Organization, Concordia University, Fall 2022
- ECON 614 Game Theory, Concordia University, Winter 2022 & Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate Level

- ECON 211 Statistical Methods I, Concordia University, Fall 2025
- ECON 301 Intermediate Microeconomics Theory I, Concordia University, Fall 2023
- ECON 485 Health Economics, Concordia University, Winter & Fall 2023
- ECON 461/561 Industrial Organization, Concordia University, Winter 2023
- ECON 464 Game Theory, Concordia University, Fall 2022
- ECON 422 Econometrics II, Concordia University, Winter 2022
- ECON 203 Macroeconomics, Concordia University, 2020–2025
- ECON 201 Microeconomics, Concordia University, 2020–2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Analyst, KYC Periodic Team, KPMG Advisory (China) Limited, Shanghai, China, Jan 2017–Feb 2018.

Market Research Assistant, Tebon Securities Co., Ltd, Shanghai, China, Aug 2016–Jan 2017.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

FRQSC Doctoral Research Scholarships (B2Z), Fonds de Recherche du Québec, 2023–2026, CAD \$58,333.
SGS Conference and Exposition Allowance, Concordia University, 2023, 2024, CAD \$2,000.
Conference Travel Funding, Faculty of Arts and Science, Concordia University, 2023, CAD \$400.
Conference Travel Funding, Department of Economics, Concordia University, 2023, 2024, CAD \$400.
Research Bursaries, CIREQ, 2023, CAD \$500.
Professor Jaleel Ahmad Scholarship, Concordia University, 2021–2022, CAD \$2,500.
International Tuition Award Excellence, Concordia University, 2020–2024, CAD \$40,656.
Graduate Fellowship, Concordia University, 2020–2024, CAD \$56,000.
Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis, Shanghai Customs College, 2018.

LANGUAGES

Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Intermediate), French (Beginner).

SKILLS

Data Analysis	MATLAB, Stata, R, EViews, SAS
Database	PostgreSQL, MySQL
Data Visualization	Power BI, Tableau
Programming Language	Python
Other	L ^A T _E X, GitHub, Microsoft Office

REFERENCES

Szilvia Pápai Associate Professor, Department of Economics Concordia University 1455 de Maisonneuve Blvd. West Montreal, Quebec H3G 1M8, Canada Tel: 1 (514) 848-2424 ext. 5016 Email: szilvia.papai@concordia.ca	Huan Xie Professor, Department of Economics Concordia University 1455 de Maisonneuve Blvd. West Montreal, Quebec H3G 1M8, Canada Tel: 1 (514) 848-2424 ext. 3927 Email: huan.xie@concordia.ca
Ming Li Professor, Department of Economics Concordia University 1455 de Maisonneuve Blvd. West Montreal, Quebec H3G 1M8, Canada Tel: 1 (514) 848-2424 Ext. 3922 Email: ming.li@concordia.ca	Xintong Han Assistant Professor, Department of Marketing Université Laval Office 5246, Pavillon Palasis-Prince 2325, rue de la Terrasse Québec, QC G1V 0A6, Canada Email: xintong.han@fsa.ulaval.ca